



ADVERTISEMENT

Virginia lawmakers debate license plate reader regulations

Now a bill circulating inside the statehouse would create guardrails around the information collected and what happens to it.

By [Henry Graff](#)

Published: Feb. 4, 2025 at 8:16 PM UTC



Share



Add Us
On Google



RICHMOND, Va. (WWBT) - Concerns are growing over exactly how law enforcement is able to track you and how that data can be used.

“Just because something catches the bad guys, so to speak, doesn’t mean it’s constitutional. We do have constitutional rights,” said Brad Haywood, [Justice Forward Virginia](#) founder.

In Virginia, we’ve seen the emergence of [Flock license plate reader](#) cameras.

Police in Richmond and Henrico are using them too.

“They are not currently regulated in Virginia, so local police departments have been able to use them as they wish and preserve the data as they wish. So there is actually a need for regulation of automatic license plate readers in Virginia,” said Haywood.

Now a bill circulating inside the statehouse would create guardrails around the information collected and what happens to it.

“This bill will limit the law enforcement use of license plate readers to active criminal investigations and matters involving missing persons, wanted persons, human trafficking, stolen vehicles and license plates,” said Del. Charniele Herring, D-4th District.

Also contained inside [House Bill 2724](#) is the ability for Virginia State Police to now have those license plate readers placed along 60,000 miles of state highways.

Right now, only local police can use them on local roads.

“This is a massive expansion of the surveillance state, and that’s what we are really concerned about,” said Haywood.

The bill, which is from a state crime commission recommendation, would also make misusing that data a class 1 misdemeanor.

“It requires that data that is stored to be destroyed within 30 days unless it is needed for on-going investigation or prosecution and it requires law enforcement to adopt a policy on license plate

The bill made it out of the House of Delegates on Tuesday on its third read and will now be considered in the state Senate.

Copyright 2025 WWBT. All rights reserved.

ADVERTISEMENT

Most Read

▶ **Double homicide of elderly man, woman under investigation in Verona**

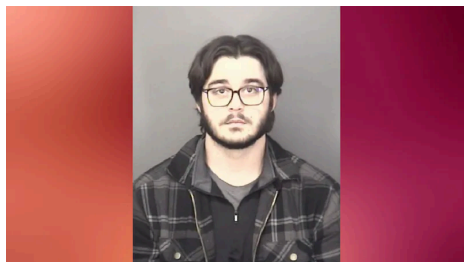


▶ **'Looking forward to my day in court': Boutique owner arrested 17 times since Jan. 1**

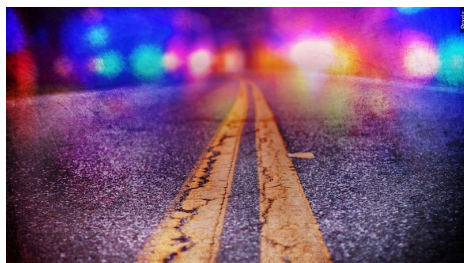


Va. wrestling coach arrested after sending child sexually explicit messages online





▶ **VSP: Driver seriously injured in single-vehicle crash on I-81 near Staunton**



▶ **The hantavirus is in the United States. Here's what we know**



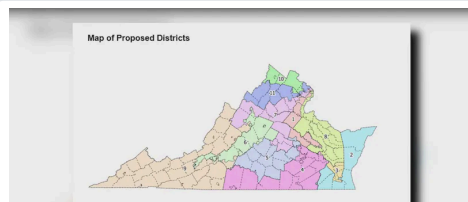
Special education bus crashes in Rockingham County with students on board



▶ **Trump says he wants to suspend federal gas tax to help address high fuel prices**



Latest News



▶ **Virginia Democrats file emergency appeal with U.S. Supreme Court over redistricting ruling**



Governor Spanberger signs paid family and medical leave law



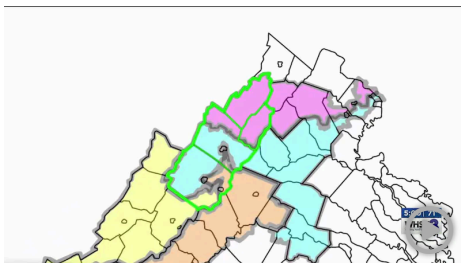
▶ **Valley political leaders react after state Supreme Court strikes down referendum**



Valley political leaders react after state Supreme Court strikes down referendum



▶ **Virginia's 6th District race shaken up after Supreme Court strikes down redistricting referendum**



Virginia leaders react to Supreme Court's ruling on redistricting



▶ **'I'm shocked': Voters react to Virginia Supreme Court voiding outcome of redistricting referendum**



[News](#)
[Sports](#)

[Weather](#)
[Contact Us](#)

WHSV
50 North Main Street
Harrisonburg, VA 22802
(540) 433-9191

[Terms of Service](#)

[Privacy Policy](#)

[EEO Statement](#)

[FCC Applications](#)

[Public Inspection File](#)

publicfile@whsv.com - (540) 433-0350

[Digital Marketing](#)

[Advertising](#)

[Closed Captioning/Audio Description](#)

[YOUR PRIVACY CHOICES](#)

[Cookie Settings](#)

[Click here to learn more about our approach to artificial intelligence.](#)

A Gray Local Media Station © 2002-2026